
Digital Detox During No Contact

Reclaim your mental space from your phone, your feeds and your ex

digitaldisconnect.shop/guides/digital-detox-during-no-contact

For many people, no contact isn't broken by a text. It's broken by a hundred small looks: their story, their likes, who they follow, when they were last online. Each look costs a bit of peace, and together they can keep you stuck for months.

A digital detox during no contact means making your phone a place your ex doesn't live anymore.

Step 1: Remove them from your feeds (without guilt)

Muting, unfollowing or blocking isn't an attack on them. It's closing a tab you keep reopening. If guilt stops you, try this framing: you're not rejecting them, you're protecting your recovery. You can always revisit the decision in a few months.

- Mute their posts and stories on every app
- Unfollow or restrict if muting isn't enough
- Block if you keep searching for them anyway
- Clear them from recent searches and suggested contacts
- Mute mutual friends who post a lot about them, for now

Step 2: Clean up your own phone

- Archive photos of the two of you into a hidden album
- Turn off "memories" and "on this day" notifications
- Archive the chat so it isn't at the top of your inbox
- Rename or hide shared playlists
- Move social apps off your home screen

Step 3: Set screen boundaries

Most social media anxiety after a split happens at predictable times: in bed, first thing in the morning, when bored or after drinking. Put limits on exactly those times:

- Phone charges outside the bedroom
- No social apps for the first 30 minutes of the day
- App timers on the platforms where you check them most
- A "no phone after midnight" rule on weekends

Step 4: Replace, don't just remove

If you delete a habit and leave a gap, the gap fills itself, usually with the old habit. Decide what you'll do in the moments you used to check: text a friend, read a few pages, go for a walk, or write a line in a journal about what you hoped to see. Writing down "what was I looking for?" is often the most revealing part of the detox.

A 7-day digital detox plan

1. Day 1: Mute or block, and clear searches.
2. Day 2: Archive photos and chats; turn off memories.
3. Day 3: Move apps off the home screen and set timers.
4. Day 4: Phone out of the bedroom tonight.
5. Day 5: A phone-free morning.
6. Day 6: Unfollow ten accounts that make you feel worse.
7. Day 7: Review: when did you want to check, and what did you do instead?

Questions people ask

Is it petty to block my ex on social media?

No. Blocking or muting is a private boundary to help you heal. It says nothing about your character, and you can change it later.

Should I delete social media entirely during no contact?

Not necessarily. For many people, muting their ex and limiting certain times is enough. If you can't stop checking, a short full break of a week or two can help.

YOUR NOTES

What I'm taking from this guide

NEXT STEP

Put it into practice for 30 days.

The No-Contact Journal is a printable 30-day guided journal: 90 prompts, a daily no-contact check-in, and a "Before you text them" page for the moments you're about to reach out.

Get it at digitaldisconnect.shop

Or start free with the 3-day starter at digitaldisconnect.shop/free

This guide is general self-help information, not therapy, medical or legal advice. If you're thinking about harming yourself, in the US call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or contact your local emergency number.

© The No-Contact Journal · Free to share in full with credit.